ARTIFICIAL VERSIFYING

OR, THE

SCHOOL-BOY'S

Recreation.

A New WAY to make

LATIN VERSES.

WHEREBY

Any one of ordinary Capacity,

that only knows the A.B.C. and can Count 9 (though he understands not one word of *Latin*, or what a *Verse* means) may be plainly taught, (and in as little a time as this is Reading over,) how to make Hundreds of *Hexameter Verses*, which shall be True *Latin*, True *Verse*, and good *Sense*.

Arithmeticæ ignarus hic ingrediatur.

Never before Publish'd.

LONDON, Printed for *John Sims* at the *King's* Head, in *Cornhil*. 1677.

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Artificial Verſifying, Or, The School-Boy's Recreation.

GREAT is the *Force* of *Numbers* in the Diſcovery of *Natures Secrets*; the *Reaſon* of *Numbers* (if we dare Credit *Solomon*, in *Wiſd.* 11. 20.) was one of the chiefeſt *Rules* according to which *God* fram'd the *World*, ſo that to ſet light by the *power* of *Numbers*, is to undervalue the *Wiſdome* of the great *Creator*, who made uſe of *them*, as the *Prime Inſtruments*, by which he *Modulated* the whole *Creation*: All the pleaſure and ſatisfaction we can receive from *Natural Speculations*, is but dull and inſipid, in compariſon to the tranſporting Complacencies, which from

thence may be extracted by *this kind* of *Harmony*, as is much better known unto every man, by how much the more he is exerciſed in *theſe Operations*.

There hath been much time and diligence beſtowed by induſtrious and learned Men of *Communicative Spirits*, of *Former Ages*, and of *late years*, to Reduce their *Arithmetical Theories* into *Practice*, to *Fit* their *Concluſions* to *Inſtrumental Work*, for the benefit of *illiterate Artificers*: And ſo ſucceſsful have their endeavors proved, that thereby *commodious Advantages* have accrued to Perſons of *diverſe Faculties*; who though they have been altogether ignorant of *Arithmetick*, and of *all Literature*, yet by the benefit of *Inſtrumental Operation*, they have been capacitated to perform ſuch *Concluſions* as their reſpective *Faculties* required, though thereof they have not been able to give a better *Reaſon*, then, *That it is ſo, becauſe it is ſo.*

Now leaſt the *Common Fidler*, (who, though ignorant in *Muſical Proportions*, can

can notwithſtanding Play *Tuneably* on his *Inſtrument.*) And leſt the *Carpenter*, *Glaſier*, or *Brick layer*, (who, though not at all Vers'd in *Arithmetick*, can by his *Rule* know the *Content* of his *Work*,) ſhould *boaſt* of their *Advantages* and *Triumph* over the *Latiniſt* and the *Poet*, I have thought Fit to Publiſh this following *Invention*, to ſtop the *Career* of their *Mechanical Oſtentation.*

For by the following *Tables*, any one of the *meaneſt* Capacity, that only knows the A. B. C. and can count 9, (though he underſtands not *one word* of *Latin*, or what a *Verſe* is) may be immediately *Taught* how to Compoſe *Hundreds* of *Hexameter Verſes*, which ſhall be *True Latin*, *True Verſe*, and *Good Senſe.*

The Versifying Tables

1.

i	s	a	t	t	h	t	p	p	m	o
s	u	r	o	u	e	e	p	r	p	r
a	r	r	s	r	i	d	e	b	s	r
p	s	f	a	i	r	i	t	i	i	i
i		d	a	d	i	d	a	m	d	b
a		a	a	a		a	a	b		b
			b							

2.

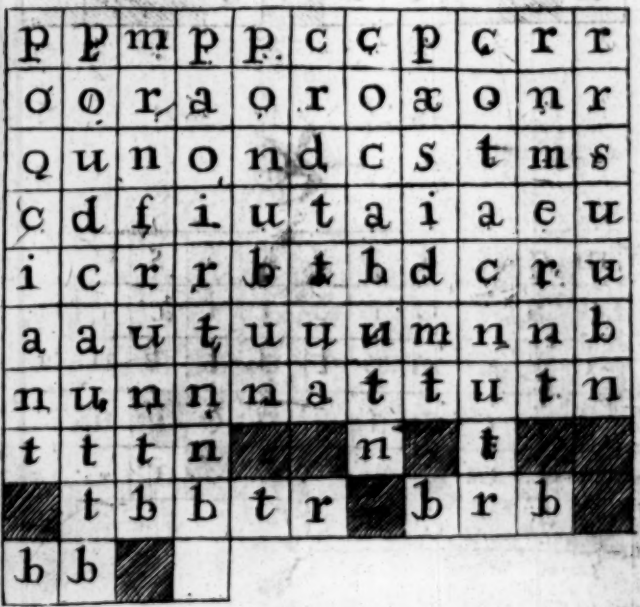
d	f	f	b	i	v	v	d	d	i	a
a	e	u	o	e	o	a	c	c	t	t
r	t	r	n	m	t	t	a	l	a	a
b	a	n	a	a		a			a	
a			b		b	i		b		

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3.



4.



·5·

s	s	p	f	ç	t	d	i	p	i
o	i	œ	r	e	o	u	o	d	m
g	d	i	m	g	r	c	e	n	n
e	m	p	m	g	u	r	i	o	r
i	o	a	i	l	a	a	r	a	n
r	t	a	a	■	■	a	■	a	a
a	■	■	b	r	■	b	■	■	■

·6·

m	q	c	t	p	s	p	s	s	u	u
e	a	l	o	r	e	æ	l	æ	r	n
a	l	a	m	p	t	d	t	t	n	a
v	p	c	a	a	a	u	e	■	a	e
■	■	m	■	m	■	b	■	r	r	b
■	b	■	d	b	r	■				

3

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The Uſe of the TABLES, and Manner of Operation.

I. YOU are to know, that every Verſe which you are to make by *theſe Tables*, will be an *Hexameter Verſe*, (ſo called, becauſe thoſe kind of *Verſes* conſiſt of *Six Feet*, neither more, nor leſs,) and will be made up of juſt Six *Latin Words*.

II. You are to Note, that every one of thoſe ſix *Words*, are orderly to be produced out of the ſix *Tables* reſpectively, *viz.* the *firſt Word* of the *Verſe* is to be wrought out of the *Firſt Table*, the *Second Word* of the *Verſe* is to be produced out of the *Second Table*, the *Third Word* is to ariſe out of the *Third Table*, and ſo the *Fourth*, *Fifth* and *Laſt Words* of the *Verſe*, are to be wrought out of the Fourth, Fifth and Sixth *Tables* reſpectively.

III. You

III. You are to underſtand, that whenever you ſhall be minded to make a *Verſe* by *theſe Tables*, you muſt ſet down on a piece of Paper any *Six* of the *Nine Figures*, called *Digits*, *viz.* 1.2.3.4.5,6.7.8.9.

But he that cannot write or reade, may conceive any *Six* of *them* in his Minde; and ſince he may be taught the Uſe of *theſe Tables*, either *by Word of Mouth*, or *by Hearing theſe Directions read*, the thing to him will be the ſame, thoroughout the whole Operation, as to him that can write and reade.

IV. Six of any of thoſe *Nine Figures* being ſet down on a *Piece of Paper*, are as ſo many reſpective *Keyes* to the Six *Tables*: The *firſt Figure* towards the left Hand, is always to be applied to the *firſt Table*, and is the *Proper Key* to *that Table*; The *ſecond Figure*, (always reckoning their places orderly towards the right Hand) is to be always appropriated to the ſecond *Table*; The *Third Figure*, in order, is as the

the proper *Key* to the *Third Table:* and ſo every one of the Six *Figures* are orderly to be applied to their reſpective *Tables*, ſo that the *firſt Figure* out of the *firſt Table* produces the *firſt* Word of the *Verſe*; the *ſecond* Figure by the ſecond *Table*, works out the *ſecond* word of the *Verſe*; and ſo the Six Figures do produce the ſix words of the Verſe out of their reſpective Tables.

V. When you have Pitched upon any ſix *Figures* to make your *Set* of, and put them down on Paper, the way to work them out ſo, that every of the ſix Figures may produce its reſpective *Latin word* out of its proper Table, (to which by its place or order it appertains) I ſay, the Rule for Operation is this, *viz.* With the *Figure* that belongs to its *proper Table*, you muſt Number on with the Columns of the ſaid Table, till you come to 9 in count upon the *Columns*, (reckoning the firſt Column of the Table always one more then the *Figure*,) at which Ninth *Column* you

you are always to make a *Stop*, (for in the whole Operation you are never to count paſt 9) and diligently mark the *Letter* you ſhall finde *therein*, and write it down on a Piece of Paper, (which is to be the *firſt* Letter of your *Latin* word,) and as diligently you are to obſerve the *Column*, wherein you found that *Letter*, (which if you miſtake, your whole Operation for *that word* will be fruſtrated,) from which Column, count the *ſucceeding Columns* till you come to the Ninth, and mark well that Ninth *Column*, and *the Letter* in it, which you muſt put down on the Paper to the *other* Letter, and ſo counting forward to the Ninth *Column*, ſee what *Letter* is *therein*, and add it to the other on the Paper, and ſo do till the *Word* is wrought out by *that Table*, which that you may know, it is ſo contrived, that when the *Word* is ended, the *laſt Count* of 9 will fall upon a *Blank-Column*.

But ſince the *Uſe* of the *Tables* will be more clear by *Example*, I ſhall ſo clearly and

and evidently declare *their uſe* by *this Set* of *Figures* (467182) working *every Figure* thorough its *proper Table*, that it ſhall be apprehended by the *meaneſt* Capacity.

Example, 467182.

The *firſt Figure* towards the left Hand being (4) belongs to the firſt *Table*, and therefore I ſhall call the *firſt Column* of that Table 5, the *ſecond* Column 6, the *third* Column 7, the *fourth* Column 8, and the *next* Column 9, at which I ſtop, and obſerving the *Letter* that is in *that* Column, which is (*t*). I ſet it down on a Piece of Paper: and becauſe it is to be the *firſt* Letter of the *firſt* word of the *Verſe*, I put it down at the beginning of a Line, and with a great *Letter* thus,

1 2 3 4 5 6

Triſtia fata tibi producunt Sidera prava:

Then the *next* Column, wherein I found that *t*, I reckon 1, the *next* Column to that 2, the next 3, and ſo I count the

Columns

Columns on in order, till I come to the Ninth *Column* from the ſaid *t*, wherein finding the *Letter* (*r*) I put it down next to *t* as above; then well marking the *Column* in which I found that *r*, I from thence count on (as I did from *t*) orderly to the ninth *Column*, and therein finding the Letter (*i*) I add *that* to *r* as above: from *this*, *i*, I reckon till I come to the ninth *Column*, wherein I finde the Letter (*s*), which putting down to *i*, as above, I go on to count from *this s*, to the ninth *Column*, and therein finding the *Letter* (*t*), I add it to *s*, as you ſee above; I proceed to reckon the ninth *Column* from this *t*, and therein finding *the Letter* (*i*), I put it down next to *t*, as above: then to the ninth *Column* from this *i*, I therein finde the Letter (*a*), which putting down next to *i*, I proceed to count on to the ninth *Column* from *a*, but therein finding a *Blank*, I thereby know that the *whole word* is wrought out, and there are to be *no more Letters* in the *firſt* word of the *Verſe*, then thoſe above, *viz. Triſtia.* To

To work out the *ſecond word* of the *Verſe* by the *ſecond Figure* in order, which is (*6*), *I* apply *it* to the ſecond Table, and call the *firſt Column* thereof 7, the *ſecond Column* in order 8, and next 9, at which *I* ſtop, and finding therein the *Letter* (*f*), *I* put it down on the paper in the *ſame* Line with *Triſtia* at a convenient diſtance, becauſe it is to begin another *word*, and beginning from the *Column* in which *I* found *f*, to count the *Columns* till *I* come to the ninth, *I* finde therein the *letter* (*a*), and putting it down to *f*, as above; from this *a* I reckon till *I* come to the ninth *Column*, *I* therein meeting with the Letter (*t*), and putting it down to *a* as before, *I* from thence count to the ninth *Column*, and finding therein the *Letter* (*a*), *I* adde it to *t*, as you ſee before, and proceed to reckon on to the ninth *Column* from thence, wherein finding a *Blank*, *I* thereby do know, that the *Word* is compoſed, and that there is to be *no more Letters* in the *ſecond word* of the *Verſe* then, *fata.*

To

To work out the *third Word* of the *Verſe* by the third *Table*, I apply to it the third *Figure* (in order in the *Set*) which is (7) and do therefore call the *firſt Column* of *that* Table 8, the ſecond *Column* 9, in which I find the *Letter* (*t*), which I put down in the ſame line next to *Fata*, at a convenient diſtance, becauſe it is to begin *another* word, from which *Column* I count till I come to the Ninth, and therein finding the *Letter* (*i*), I put it down to *t*, as before, and from thence reckoning to the Ninth *Column*, I there Find the *letter* (*b*), which adding to *i*, (as you ſee before) I from thence count to the ninth *Column*, and therein Finding the *Letter* (*i*) I put it down to (*b*), and counting from this *i*, to the Ninth *Column*, I there do Find a *Blank*, by which I know that there are to be *no more Letters* in the third *Word* of this *Verſe* then, *tibi*.

To Work out the fourth *Word* of the *Verſe*, I apply the *fourth Figure* in order in the Set, which is (1) to the fourth *Table*, and

and count the *firſt Column* thereof 2, the *ſecond Column* 3, and ſo on till I come to the Ninth *Column*, wherein finding the *Letter* (*p*) I put it down at a convenient diſtance from the Word *tibi*, in the *ſame* line (it being the *firſt Letter* of another *Word*) and counting to the Ninth *Column* from *p*, I therein find the Letter (*r*) which putting down to *p*, (as you may ſee done before) I from thence reckoning to the Ninth *Column*, do therein find the *Letter* (*o*) which I add to *r*, and from thence counting to the Ninth *Column*, I there meet the *Letter* (*d*) which I put down next to *o*, and from thence I go on to the Ninth *Column*, wherein finding the *Letter* (*u*) I add it to *d*, and from thence count to the Ninth *Column*, and therein finding the *Letter* (*c*), I put it down next to *u*, and counting from thence to the Ninth *Column*, I find therein the *Letter* (*u*), which putting to *c*, I reckon from thence to the Ninth *Column*, and finding therein the *Letter* (*n*), I add it to *u*, and counting

from thence to the ninth *Column*, I find there the *Letter* (*t*), which putting down next to *n*, I proceed to count from thence to the ninth *Column*, in which finding a *Blank*, *I* thereby know that the fourth *Word* of *this Verſe* is wrote out, and that that it hath *no more letters*, then *producunt*.

To work out the *fifth word* of the *Verſe*, *I* apply the fifth *Figure* in order (which is 8) to the fifth *Table*, and counting the firſt *Column* thereof 9, *I* there make a ſtop, and finding therein the *letter* (*s*), *I* put it down (as you ſee above) at a fit diſtance from the word *producunt*, and from thence counting to the ninth *Column*, *I* therein find the *letter* (*i*), and ſetting it down next to *s*, *I* from thence reckon to the ninth *Column*, and finding there the *letter* (*d*) *I* add it to *i*, from whence counting to the ninth *Column*, *I* find therein the *letter* (*e*) which *I* put down next to *d*, and counting from thence to the ninth *Column*, *I* there find the *letter* (*r*), which *I* add to *e*, and proceed to reckon from thence to the ninth

ninth *Column*, in which Finding the *letter* (*a*) *I* put it down to *r*, and numbring from thence to the ninth *Column*, *I* Find there a *Blank*, by which *I* know that there are to be *no more letters* in the Fifth *Word* of the *Verſe*, then *Sidera*.

To work out the *ſixth* and *laſt Word* of the *Verſe*, *I* apply the *ſixth* and *laſt Figure*, *viz.* 2, to the *ſixth* and *laſt Table*, and counting the *firſt Column* thereof 3, the next 4, and forwards till *I* come to the ninth *Column*, wherein Finding the *letter* (*p*) *I* write it down at a convenient diſtance from the Word *Sidera*, and from the *Column* wherein *I* found this *p*, *I* count to the ninth *Column*, and therein Finding the *letter* (*r*) I write it down next to *p*, and reckoning on to the ninth *Column* from thence, *I* Find therein the *letter* (*a*), which putting down next to *r*, *I* reckon from thence to the ninth *Column*, wherein finding the *letter* (*v*), I add it to *a*, and counting from thence to the ninth *Column*, *I* do therein Find the *letter* (*a*), and putting it

down next to *v*, *I* from thence proceed to count to the ninth *Column*, and Finding therein a *Blank*, *I* thereby underſtand that this Word is ended, and there are to be *no more letters* in the *ſixth* and *laſt Word* of the *Verſe*, then *prava.*

By which ſeveral *Operations* I have made it plain to you, that in this *Set of Figures*, (467182) the *Figure* (4) in the *firſt* place produceth the *firſt word* of the *Verſe*, *Triſtia*; the *Figure* (6) in the *ſecond* place bringeth out the *ſecond word*, *Fata*; the *Figure* (7) in the *Third* place produceth the *third word*, *tibi*; the *Figure* (1) in the *fourth* place worketh out the *fourth word*, *producunt:* the *Figure* (8) in the *fifth* place formeth out the *fifth word*, *Sidera*, and that the *Figure* (2) in the *ſixth* and *laſt place* doth work out the *ſixth* and *laſt word* of the *Verſe*, *Prava.* Every of which *6 words* being wrote down on a piece of Paper (as before is taught) as they were wrought out, makes this *Hexameter Verſe.*

Triſtia

Triſtia fata tibi producunt ſidera prava.

As to the *Trueneſs* of the *Latin*, and the *Verſe*, I *appeal* to any ingenious *Grammarian*, and as to the *Senſe*, I could wiſh the *Phyſiologiſts* had not ſubſcribed *their Probatum eſt.*

You muſt *Remember*, that when you put the *Figure* 9 amongſt any *Set* of *Figures*, and appropriate it to its *proper Table*, you always count the *firſt Column* of *that Table*, as 1, the next *Column* 2, and ſo reckon on till you come to the Ninth, and ſo to proceed in the *Operation*, as with any other *Figure.*

As for *Example*, you will find done in this *Set* of *Figures* (988978) (where the *Figure* 9 is in the *firſt* and *fourth place*) which being workt out by *theſe Tables*, produceth this *Verſe*:

Perfida dicta mihi confirmant ſomnia multa.

Which *Set* of *Figures* if you place exactly *backwards*, thus (879889) you will have a *Verſe* wrought out conſiſting of *Latin words* quite *different* from the former, which make an abſolute *Alteration* in the *Senſe* alſo: For you are to know, that the *Alteration* of the place of any of the ſix *Figures*, (you propoſe to make your *Set* of) produceth a *Verſe different* in *Words* and *Senſe*: You will find the laſt inverted *Set* of *Figures* (if truly workt out by *their* reſpective *Tables*) to yield this *Verſe*.

Impia facta, ſcio, prædicunt ſidera ſæpe.

By every way changing the *Figures* places will be produced ſuch *variety* of different *Latin words* to compoſe *Verſes* of, cauſing ſuch various *Alteration* in their *Senſe*, that theſe *Operations* cannot but prove very delightful to him that underſtands the *Latin Tongue*; and not a little grateful to *him* takes pleaſure in the Power of *Numbers*.

FINIS.

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